



Droid X sells out

Motorola's Droid X sold out online on the first day and is running short on supply



HP Designjet 3D

HP's Designjet 3D printer is capable of turning 3D CAD drawings to tangible prototypes using molten plastic layers on top of one another to give 3D models

HP Photosmart C4688 and C4788

HP sent us two printers from the Photosmart series namely C4688 and C4788. Both these printers are completely iden-



HP Photosmart C4688

tical except for the fact that C4788 has the WiFi connectivity option whereas the C4688 does not. Both the models are all-in-ones having functionality of scanning and copying apart from the regular printing. The all-in-ones come in an all



HP Photosmart C4788

black glossy body with the HP logo emblazoned on the top panel. The front panel is somewhat unconventional in terms of aesthetics as it isn't smooth one body front panel. It is covered by the input feeder tray which reveals the printer paper rollers on opening. To insert the tri-channel colour and black cartridge, one has to open the front panel after lowering the input feeder tray. There is no paper collection or output tray. The paper comes out from the front portion. A grey plastic extender tray is located under the input tray which when ejected out lies perpendicular to the input tray and prevents the output paper

Contact Sheet

Brand	Contact	Phone	E-mail	Website
Canon	Canon India Pvt Ltd	1800 345 3366	info@canon.co.in	www.canon.co.in
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HP	HP India	99535 99212	bharat.kharbada@hp.com	www.hp.com

from falling off. Tray quality is quite sturdy in both the printers. Apart from the power button, there is no other button on either of the all-in-ones.

A 1.45-inch colour LCD screen is located on the left hand top edge. We felt that the screen size is quite small and the fonts used even smaller. However, the touch sensitive controls located around the screen are a welcomed addition. There are three controls like OK, back and don't select (denoted by an X) on the left hand side whereas three selection slits on the right hand side.

Performance

HP Photosmart printers are slow operators. Pain-

fully so in some cases. Photo 2 and Photo 3 took over 5 minutes for C4788 and around 7 minutes for C4688. The quality was not the best among all the printers. It fared well in the sample photo tests (photo 1 and photo 2) but in the portrait photo (photo 3) it was not that great. C4688 tended to oversaturate the colours giving. Also, the skin tones looked somewhat overtly bright in C4688. Printing off a memory card also took 249 seconds and 302 seconds for C4788 and C4688 respectively.

Price: ₹7,570 (C4688) and ₹6,267 (C4688)

Epson Stylus Photo R1900

An upgrade from the older R1800, the Epson Stylus Photo printer R1900 was the only A3 photo printer that we tested. This printer occupies a lot of space thanks to its relatively

greater dimensions to accommodate the A3 paper. Both the input feeder tray and output collector tray extend outwards from the plane of the printer, so you need sufficient space on your desk to accommodate the R1900.

It comes in a black and silver body. There is no operational panel, only four buttons on the top. It has very limited connectivity options. There is a PictBridge slot on the lower left hand corner. R1900 does not have network connectivity, instead it has two USB interfaces to connect to two systems at a time.

This printer has as many as eight cartridges. There are two black cartridges namely Glossy black (GBK) for glossy paper prints and matte black (MBK) for matte photo papers. In addition to the regular cyan, magenta and yellow cartridges there are red and orange car-

HOW WE TESTED

For the photo printer we used the same rig as we have used for all the printers in the past i.e. an Intel Pentium 4 with 2 GB of RAM. As this was a photo printer test, we had tested the printers using three test photographs. Photo 1 was the photo we use for all our printer tests, which covers a wide gamut of objects, patterns, faces etc. Photo 2 was another sample photo which had only objects shot against a black backdrop. This helped us assess the quality of black colour printed. Photo 3 was a human portrait showing two sisters. We also included one mixed document print test to check all

the printers, as you would also use the photo printer to print documents.

We identified 6-7 regions in each of the photograph and gave a score out of 10 to each region as compared to other printers. An average of this score was assigned as the Quality score in the log sheet. This was done so as to cover all aspects of the printout rather than be biased by one particular aspect of the printout.

Apart from the printer performance, we also gave points to the features offered by the printer. Those having extra connectivity options like PictBridge, memory

card support, wifi, network etc had an edge over others. Ease of installation, build quality and printer setup was also evaluated for each printer.

Although we had given clear instructions to all the participating brands that we were testing only the photo printing prowess of the printer, we got a couple of printers with a scanner and copier functionality. So to prevent an unfair advantage to the pure photo printers, we did not allot any weightage to copiers and scanners. But just to give you an idea of their importance, we recorded the timings.